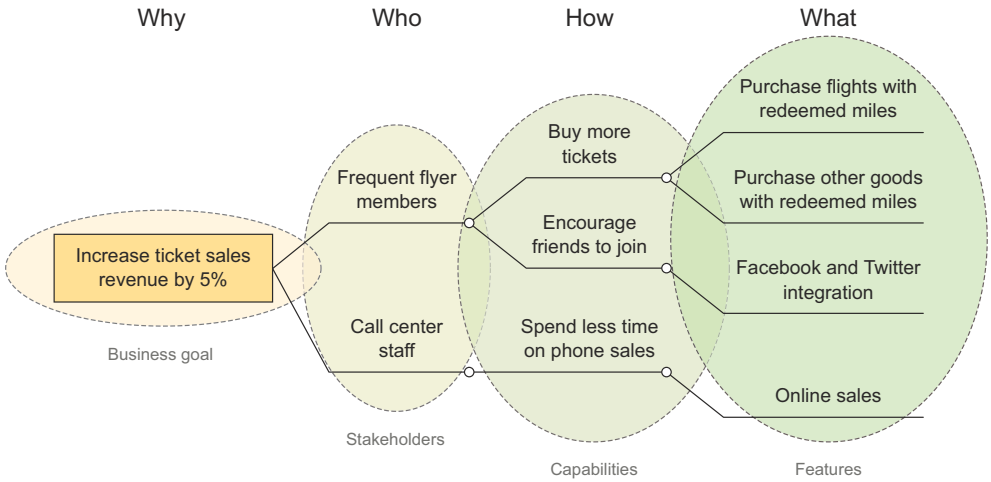


Figure 3.10 Impact maps are a good way to explore goals, capabilities, and features at a high level.

In another situation, they needed to be able to deliver reliable service to property managers in rural areas, where internet connections are notoriously slow:

```
Capability: To provide a viable service in rural areas
In order to benefit from the service when working in remote rural areas
As a property manager
I want to be able to still use the essential features of the system
     effectively over a slow internet connection
```

From here on in, they were able to start having conversations about features that they could build to deliver these capabilities: what sort of statistics would a property owner need to see, what would it look like on the screen, what would the user experience be like for the property owner, and so on.

Features are the implemented components in an application that deliver a capability to the users. For example, several different features might have helped the development team deliver the "provide property owners easy access to their statements" capability mentioned previously, such as a property dashboard page on the client website or an iPhone property-management dashboard app. We'll discuss the concept of features in much more detail in the next chapter.

Impact maps, as you saw earlier, can help you explore these ideas at a higher level, before discussing each capability or feature in more detail (see figure 3.10).

3.8 What features will provide the most ROI? The Purpose-Based Alignment Model

Feature Injection can help you decide what features you really must have in order to deliver the business value you need to deliver. But there's another dimension that's also worth considering. Not all features are equal. Some features will be areas of innovation, requiring specialized domain knowledge and expertise and adding significant